

all that live.¹ I call the Right to come to me with good destiny.²

11. What man is a friend to Spitama Zarathushtra, O Mazda? Who will let himself be counselled by Right? With whom³ is holy Piety? Or who as an upright man is intent on the covenant⁴ of Good Thought?

12. The Kavi's wanton⁵ did not please Zarathushtra Spitama at the Winter Gate, in that he stayed him from taking refuge with him, and when there came to him also (Zarathushtra's) two steeds shivering with cold.

13. Thus the Self of the Liar destroys for himself the assurance of the right Way; whose soul shall tremble at the Revelation⁶ on the Bridge of the Separater, having turned aside with deeds and tongue from the path of Right.

14. The Karapans⁷ will not obey the statutes and ordinances concerning husbandry. For the pain they inflict on the cattle, fulfil upon them through their actions and judgements that judgement which at the last shall bring them to the House of the Lie.

15. What meed Zarathushtra hath promised to the men of his covenant,⁸ (which) in the House of Song Ahura Mazda hath first attained, for all this I have looked through your blessings, Good Thought, and those of Right.

16. Kavi Vishtaspa hath accepted that creed which the holy Mazda Ahura with Right hath devised, together with the dominion of the Covenant,⁴ and the path of Good Thought. So be it accomplished after our desire.

It only occurs once in the Gathas, which is insufficient evidence for the establishment of the usage so early. Probably the Magi based their appropriation on the accident of the use here.

¹ *duž-dā yōi hantī*, the antithesis of *huddā yōi hantī* in *Ys* 45⁶.

² *Aša* to come with *aši vanuhī*. See p. 360.

³ *Kd* instr. (Bartholomae). Geldner makes it nom. sg. fem., "Was gilt die heilige Ârmaiti?"

⁴ *Magdī*, a doubtful word. Bartholomae "Bund," Geldner "Gnadengate." See note on *Ys* 29¹¹.

⁵ *vaēpayō* = *παϊδικά*: Geldner makes it a proper name. Bartholomae lays just emphasis on the convincing reality of this personal reminiscence: see above, p. 83.

⁶ *ākā*: see notes on *Ys* 48⁸, 50²⁻⁴.

⁷ See p. 140.

⁸ *magavabyō*: see note on *magāi* in v.¹¹ and in *Ys* 29¹¹.

17. The fair form of one that is dear hath Frashaoshtra Hvogva promised unto me :¹ may sovran Mazdah Ahura grant that she attain possession of the Right for her good Self.

18. This creed Jamaspa Hvogva² chooses through Right, lordly in substance.³ This Dominion they (choose) who have part in Good Thought. This grant me, Ahura, that they may find in thee, Mazdah, their protection.

19. This man,⁴ O Maidyoimaongha Spitama,⁵ hath set this before him after conceiving it in his own Self. He that would see Life indeed, to him will he make known what in actions by Mazdah's ordinance is better during (this) existence.

20. Your blessings shall ye give us, all ye that are one in will, with whom Right, Good Thought, Piety, and Mazdah (are one), according to promise, giving your aid when worshipped with reverence.

21. By Piety the beneficent man benefits⁶ the Right through his thinking, his words, his action, his Self. By Good Thought Mazdah Ahura will give the Dominion. For this good Destiny⁷ I long.

22. He, I ween, that Mazdah Ahura knoweth, among all that have been and are, as one to whom in accordance with

¹ Hvôvi, the daughter of Frashaoshtra : see p. 82. The possibilities of these Gathic problems are well illustrated here by Geldner's version, "Einen begehrenswerten Leib hat mir F. H. für seine gute Seele ausgemalt." He notes "D. h. er hat ihm geschildert, welchen schönen Leib er im Paradies für seine gläubige Seele erbittet : vgl. Ys 36⁶," where prayer is offered for the "fairest of all bodies," to be the worshipper's portion. The reference to the Prophet's new bride seems *a priori* probable in a stanza referring to his father-in-law, and Bartholomae's rendering seems to me preferable. A passage from the Gatha Haptanghaiti is not the best of parallels for the elucidation of the older Gathas.

² Frashaoshtra's brother, and Zarathushtra's son-in-law—see Ys 53.

³ Geldner joins *istōiṣ xšaθrēm*, "das Reich des Wunsches," the looked-for Kingdom of God.

⁴ M. himself (Bartholomae).

⁵ *Maidyōi-mānha*, a cousin of the Prophet, and his earliest convert, according to tradition. See p. 82.

⁶ *Spəntō—spəntat*. Bartholomae, who will not allow "beneficent" as the meaning of *spənta*—on which see p. 145—regards this as a paronomasia. He renders "By Piety one becomes holy. Such a man advances Right by . . .," etc. So now Brugmann, *Grundriss*², II. iii. 329.

⁷ *vanhvīm ašim* : see note on v. 10.

Right the best portion falls for his prayer, these will I reverence¹ by their names and go before them with honour.

GATHA VAHIŠTŌ-IŠTI

Yasna 53

1. *Zarathushtru*.—The best possession known is that of Zarathushtra Spitama, which is that Mazda Ahura will give him through the Right the glories of blessed life unto all time, and likewise to them that practise and learn the words and actions of his Good Religion.

2. Then let them seek the pleasure of Mazda with thought, words, and actions, unto his praise gladly, and seek his worship, even the Kavi Vishtaspa, and Zarathushtra's son² the Spitamid, and Frashaoshtra, making straight the paths for the Religion of the future Deliverer which Ahura ordained.

3. Him, O Pourucista,³ thou scion of Haēcataspa and Spitama, youngest of Zarathushtra's daughters, hath (Zarathushtra) appointed as one to enjoin on thee a fellowship with Good Thought, Right, and Mazda. So take counsel with thine own understanding: with good insight practise the holiest works of Piety.

4. *Jamaspa*.—Earnestly will I lead her to the Faith,⁴ that she may serve her father and her husband, the farmers and the nobles,⁵ as a righteous woman (serving) the righteous. The glorious heritage of Good Thought [. . . three syllables corrupt . . .] shall Mazda Ahura give to her good Self for all time.

5. *Zarathushtra*.—Teachings address I to maidens marry-

¹ *yazāi*—here only in the Gathas applied to men. As suggested in *ERPP*, 118, it seems a little suspicious: later worship, as in *Yt* 13 *passim*, used it freely of the *fravashi* of a living man. On the *yēohē hātām* (*Ys* 27¹⁵) as adapted from this stanza, see *ERPP*, 117.

² *Išaṭ.vāstra* by name (see p. 82): it does not happen to occur in the Gathas, which only refer to him here.

³ On *Pourucista* and *Haēcataspa* (fourth progenitor of Zarathushtra, in the fifth generation from Spitama) see pp. 82, 375.

⁴ *nīvarānī*: so Bartholomae divides, with two good MSS. Geldner's standard text reads *spərədānī varānī*.

⁵ *x'aētavē*, "the clan." On the castes see p. 117.